

Freecom FM-1 USB Stick - 64 MB

Your data warehouse

Freecom's FM-1 USB Stick is a small, thumb-sized, lightweight external storage device that is extremely simple to use—just plug it into any USB port and it gets automatically detected in Windows XP and 2000 as a removable drive. For Windows 98, drivers are provided in the accompanying CD. Once you plug in the device, you get a removable drive added to the Windows Explorer window. You're now ready to share data—just copy files to the drive. An LED on the drive blinks to show that data is being transferred. It also comes with a USB cable in case your USB port is in a difficult-to-reach place.

The FM-1 is ideal for storing and sharing digital pictures, music files, text files,

spreadsheets and presentations—basically, just about anything that you might need to carry around with you. Despite its size, the construction is quite rugged—it is designed to resist water and dust.

It transfers 64 MB of data in just 3 minutes. The accompanying CD contains drivers for Windows 98 SE, password protection software for Windows, a quick install guide and the software manual.

However, given its 64 MB storage capacity, the FM-1 is useful for people who have to share small amounts of data between computers. For people who have greater data storage or transferring needs, there are alternatives available with capacities of up to 1 GB.

Price: Rs 7,500
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SPECIFICATIONS

64 MB capacity, USB 1.1 interface, data access rate of over 1 MBps (read) and 800 KBps (write), data retention up to 10 years, multifunctional LED indicates power on (green) and read/write access (red), OS support for Windows 98 SE/Me/2000/XP, MAC OS 9/10.x, Linux 2.4

Package contents: Freecom FM-1 USB Stick (weatherproof), Security Password Protection software, Software Suite including Auto Mail, PC Lock, Secure & Zip, Magic Disk, preinstalled on USB stick and included on CD, USB connection cable (extension cable from desktop back panel to stick), neck strap

Freecom FM-1 USB Stick 64 MB	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ease of use	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Odyssey ATX-403A computer case

Of roses and thorns

The ATX-403A is a mini-tower case designed for Pentium 4 systems.

First the good things: the case has a 350 watt power supply—enough for high-end systems not too loaded with USB devices or a DVD writer. There's a separate power con-

necter for the monitor. There's a hot air vent and an exhaust fan at the bottom of the SMPS, bang over the CPU once the motherboard is fixed, and a blowhole and fan near the top. Also featured is a screw-less design for opening the case—a single thumb-

screw holds the whole arrangement in place. Even the expansion cards are held in place by plastic locking arrangements; however, these do not sit perfectly on large cards such as Creative's Sound-Blaster Audigy2.

The icing on the cake is the cool blue power LED.

Now for the bad things: the SMPS has only four large and one small power connector—a big disadvantage if you have a Radeon 9700, Audigy 2 or a floppy drive, all of which need a small connec-

tor. Everything in the case is riveted, making it difficult to add or remove drives. The power supply connector of the motherboard slightly obstructs the audio cable. Also, the RAM sticks slightly block the hard disk.

Overall, it's a worthy product, that is if you don't mind the price (Rs 2,080).

SPECIFICATIONS

Mini tower, P4-compliant power supply, 350 watt power rating, side-mounted USB and sound connectors

Odyssey ATX-403A Computer Case	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

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